



1.2–1.9 m  
4–6¼ ft

**AMERICAN BLACK BEAR**  
*Ursus americanus*

With about 850,000–950,000 individuals across varied habitats in N. America, this is the world's most common bear. Some have brown or blond fur.



1.1–1.9 m  
3½–6¼ ft

**ASIATIC BLACK BEAR**  
*Ursus thibetanus*

A widespread forest-dweller, this bear is variable in appearance, habitat, and behaviour. In the tropics, only pregnant females hibernate.



1.8–2.8 m  
6–9¼ ft

**POLAR BEAR**  
*Ursus maritimus*

One of the largest predators on land, the polar bear is equally at home in water. It spends most of its life on Arctic sea ice.

partially furred  
paw-pads provide  
extra grip on ice

relatively  
long neck



1.3–1.9 m  
4¼–6¼ ft

**SPECTACLED BEAR**  
*Tremarctos ornatus*

A vulnerable species of Andean cloud forests, this bear is an excellent climber. Its varied diet includes fruits, shoots, and meat.



1.4–1.9 m  
4½–6¼ ft

**SLOTH BEAR**  
*Melursus ursinus*

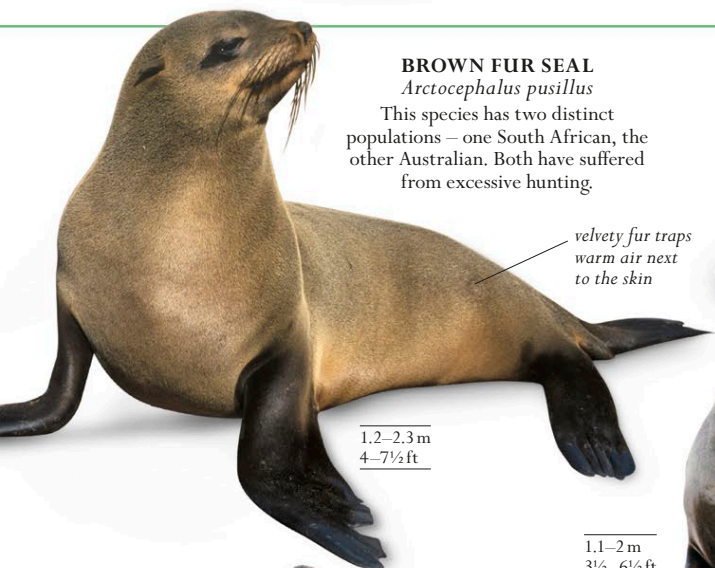
This shaggy Indian bear can live in a range of habitats. It uses its huge claws to open termite mounds, sucking up the panicking insects.



1–1.5 m  
3¼–5 ft

**SUN BEAR**  
*Helarctos malayanus*

This shy S.E. Asian forest bear eats insects, honey, fruits, and plant shoots. It is active by day, becoming nocturnal if disturbed.



**BROWN FUR SEAL**  
*Arctocephalus pusillus*

This species has two distinct populations – one South African, the other Australian. Both have suffered from excessive hunting.

velvety fur traps  
warm air next  
to the skin



1.1–1.6 m  
3½–5¼ ft

**GALAPAGOS FUR SEAL**  
*Arctocephalus galapagoensis*

The smallest of the eared seals, this species is also the least variable, with males only slightly larger than females.



**GUADALUPE FUR SEAL**  
*Arctocephalus townsendi*

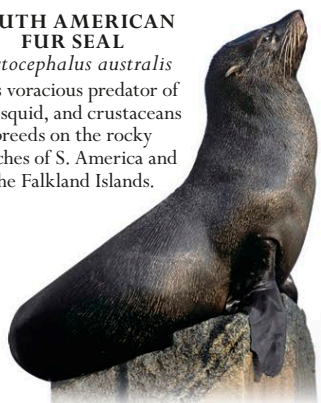
Distinguished by its long, tapering nose, this fur seal breeds on rocky beaches and caves accessible only from the sea.



1.2–2 m  
4–6½ ft

**SOUTH AMERICAN FUR SEAL**  
*Arctocephalus australis*

This voracious predator of fish, squid, and crustaceans breeds on the rocky beaches of S. America and the Falkland Islands.



1.5–1.9 m  
5–6¼ ft

**ANTARCTIC FUR SEAL**  
*Arctocephalus gazella*

This species breeds on the scattered islands of the Southern Ocean. It is recovering from excessive hunting in the past.



**NEW ZEALAND FUR SEAL**  
*Arctocephalus forsteri*

This seal breeds on the rocky coasts of New Zealand and Australia. Now protected by law, it is no longer hunted and its numbers are increasing.

1.5–1.9 m  
5–6¼ ft

massive  
neck with a  
coarse mane

fore flippers

pointed muzzle